Bergen Raises of a Major After a Double - BROMAD

Print Page Download PDF

1.2k Shares

Email Share Post

BROMAD is an acronym for "Bergen Raises of a Major After a Double". It is a set of conventional raises by responder after hearing a 1♥/♠ opening bid and an opposing takeout double:

Bid	Meaning
Redouble	A redouble is not part of BROMAD per se, but is worth mentioning. It shows 10+ points and denies 3+ card support.
2♣	A 3-card "Constructive" raise, showing 7-10 points and exactly 3-card trump support.
2♦	A 3-card "Limit" raise or better, showing 10+ points and exactly 3-card trump support.
2♥/♠	A 3-card "Preemptive" raise, showing 0-6 points and exactly 3-card trump support.
2NT	A preempt in clubs or diamonds (i.e. a hand that would normally make a 3♣ or 3♦ weak jump shift).
3♣	A 4-card "Constructive" raise, showing 7-10 points and exactly 4-card trump support.
3♦	A 4-card "Limit" raise, showing 10-12 points and exactly 4-card trump support.
3♥/♠	A 4-card "Preemptive" raise, showing 0-6 points and exactly 4-card trump support.

BROMAD assumes that the partnership plays 5-card majors. The theory is to reach the correct level of bidding in accordance with the Law of Total Tricks.

Note that the preemptive direct raises (i.e. 1♠ : 2/3♠) are based on the principle of fast arrival. They are designed to rob the opponents of bidding space as quickly as possible.

The BROMAD 3-level responses are identical to Bergen raises, which are systemic raises used in uncontested auctions.

Examples

West	East
♠ AK543	♠ T98
♥ T43	♥ J9
♦ A	♦ KQJ52
♣ Q984	♣ JT2

West	North	East	South
1♠	Dbl	2♣ [1]	Pass
2♠ [2]	Pass	Pass	Pass

[1] A constructive 3-card raise.
[2] A sign-off bid showing a minimum.

West	East
♠ AK543	♠ T98
♥ KT3	♥ 8752
♦ Q984	♦ —
♣ A	♣ JT7632

West	North	East	South
1♠	Dbl	2♠ [1]	Pass
Pass	Pass		

[1] A preemptive 3-card raise.

West	East
♠ K4	♠ T98
♥ KQJ532	♥ 6
♦ QJ	♦ AT98765
♣ A53	♣ J9

West	North	East	South
1♥	Dbl	2NT [1]	Pass
3♣ [2]	Pass	3♦	Pass
Pass	Pass		

[1] A weak minor-suiter. 0-6 points and 7-card suit.
[2] A relay to pass or correct.

Origins

BROMAD was created by American expert Marty Bergen in the 1980s.

See also

- Bergen Game Try
  An artificial 2NT game try by opener after the auction begins 1M:2M.
- Bergen Raises
  A method of raising 1♥/♠ opening bids that includes weak jump raises.
- Interview with Marty Bergen
  An interview with the inventor of BROMAD and Bergen Raises.
- Jordan 2NT
  An artificial 2NT raise after an opposing takeout double. Promises limit raise strength or better.
- The Law of Total Tricks
  A bidding philosophy based on trump-suit fits around the table.